There was complete confusion. Multiple power centres, typical of the Congress, were emerging. Dentsu threw up its hands; finally, the party's media team took up the matter with Sonia. Manoj was packed off back to America. 'In all the confusion, we lost valuable time. It was a completely unnecessary distraction,' admits a Dentsu team member. By the time the agency was ready with its second phase of the campaign, it was too late.

One big difference between the two campaigns was that the BJP's had simple and clear messaging; the Congress campaign was tangled in jargon and tended to use long-winded words, especially in Hindi. For example, its ads used words like *arajakta* (anarchy), *kaajniti* (work policy) and *sashaktikaran* (empowerment). 'Who the hell uses such bureaucratic language today? This was the worst form of language used by Doordarshan in another era!' is how one advertising professional describes the Congress campaign's failure.

There was also a lack of clarity on the Congress's target audience.

Suddenly, in March, the agency was told that the new focus was to be the so-called 'sandwich class'—not rich, not middle class, not BPL (abbreviated to NRMB). Rahul's adviser, Mohan Gopal, had pointed out that about 700 million Indians, mainly from the unorganized sector, live in this income group and the party needed to shine a light on this group which had derived maximum benefit from UPA-II's policy initiatives. Decoding NRMB may have been an interesting talking point in a seminar, but how would the image be captured in an election advertising campaign? A new ad line was coined: *'Bharat ke Mazboot Haath, Hum Sab Hain Ek Saath.'* (India's Strong Hands, We Are All One.) 'The voter wanted answers to questions of corruption and inflation, and we were giving them some upbeat stuff—it was never going to work,' is the candid admission from Dentsu. Gopal counters, 'The ad agency just didn't understand what the unorganized sector was all about and how to reach out to them.' Many Congressmen insist that it was the sheer money power of the BJP that gave them an added edge. 'The Congress is a poor party with rich individuals; the BJP in 2014 was a rich party with wealthy individuals,' is how Ramesh describes it. A BJP insider insists that the final ad campaign bill was around